

Dental Care

Quick Tips – Care Guide



From the Sarcoma Oncology Center

You want to let your oncologist know about any dental work you've scheduled, and update your dentist about your cancer treatment. These conversations will help in maintaining the best dental health possible during your cancer treatment.

Prior to a dental appointment, you want to check with your oncologist first. If you are taking medicine that could affect a dental procedure, you might have to delay treatment or ask your dentist if an alternate method could be performed.

Before You Start Sarcoma Treatment

Before starting treatment, talk with your oncologist about how cancer therapy may affect your dental health. If you need extensive dental work, try to schedule it either before treatment begins or after it is complete. Be sure to tell your oncologist if you have an oral infection, as it may need to be treated first.

Addressing dental issues early can help prevent interruptions to your cancer treatment. Once treatment starts, staying on schedule is important because delays may affect the effectiveness of chemotherapy.

When discussing dental health with your oncologist, consider asking:

- What does my dentist need to know?
- How might treatment affect my dental health?
- Are there any dental procedures I should avoid?
- When is the best time to schedule dental procedures?
- How can I maintain good oral health during treatment?

You should also schedule a dental checkup and let your dentist know about your upcoming cancer treatment. Taking care of this in advance will give you one less thing to worry about, so you can stay focused on your recovery.

During Your Sarcoma Treatment

Chemotherapy can cause several common oral side effects, but there are ways to manage them:

- **Dry mouth:** Use a mouth rinse or artificial saliva, and drink water regularly to stay hydrated.
- **Mouth sores:** Rinse your mouth often and use topical treatments as recommended.
- **Gum disease:** Help prevent problems by using fluoride toothpaste and an oral rinse. If gum disease develops, your doctor or dentist may recommend an anti-inflammatory or steroid rinse.
- **Infection:** Reduce your risk with regular brushing and flossing. If you notice signs of infection, see your dentist right away.
- **Stiff jaw:** Talk with your oncologist about possible treatment options.

Some chemotherapy drugs can also cause specific side effects, such as **mucositis** (painful mouth sores). Fortunately, newer medications and supportive treatments are available to help prevent and manage these side effects, improving comfort and helping protect your quality of life and nutritional health.

Resources

[National LMS Foundation](#)

[Cancer Treatment & Your Teeth](#)

[Dental Considerations During Cancer](#)

[The Importance of Oral Care During Treatment](#)



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